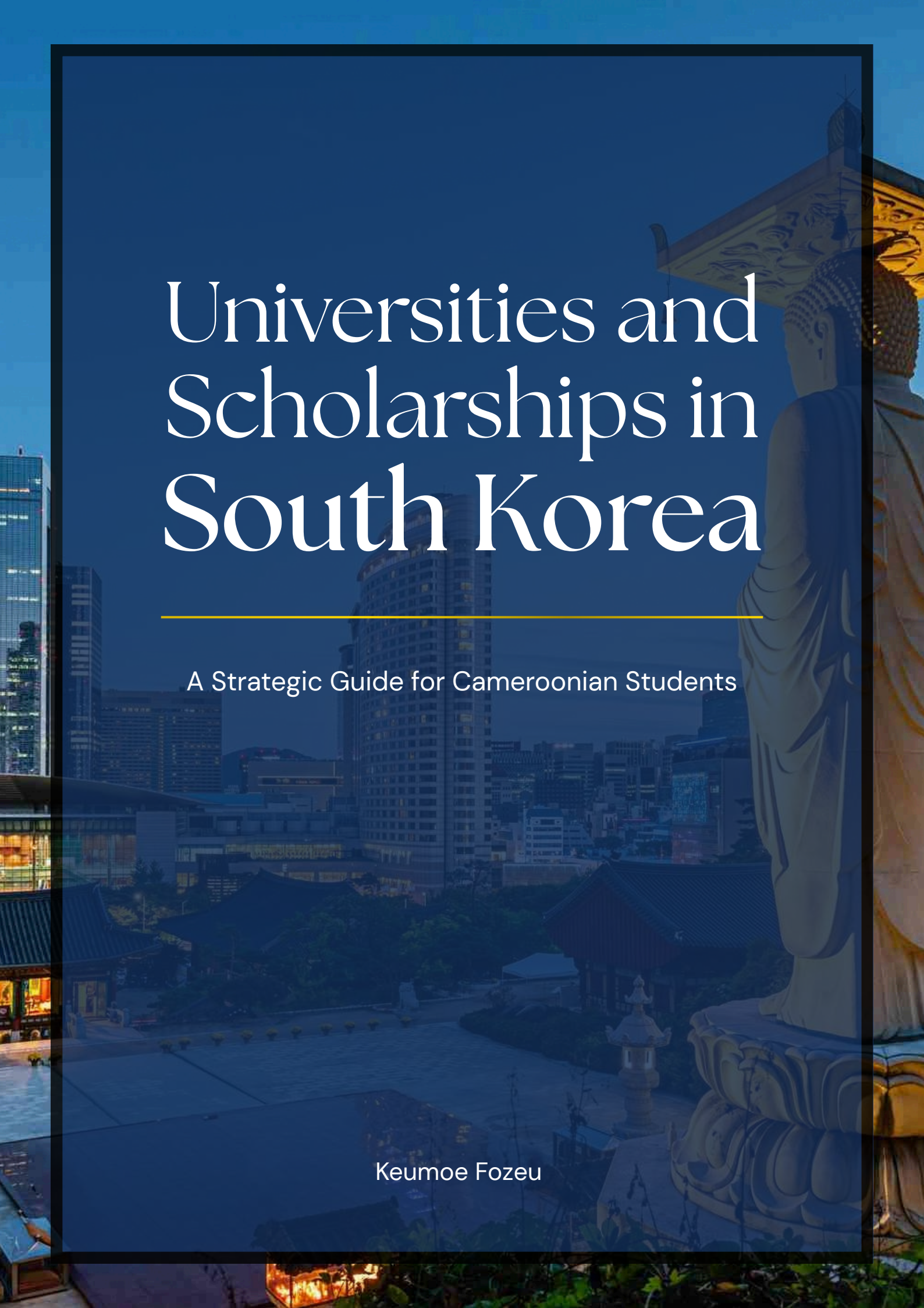


The background of the cover is a composite image. On the right side, there is a large, golden Buddha statue, likely the Gyeongju Daereomgyo, which is partially visible. The rest of the background is a night-time photograph of a South Korean city, showing various skyscrapers and traditional Korean architecture with tiled roofs. The image is overlaid with a dark blue gradient.

Universities and Scholarships in South Korea

A Strategic Guide for Cameroonian Students

Keumoe Fozeu

UNIVERSITIES AND SCHOLARSHIPS IN SOUTH KOREA

A Strategic Guide for Cameroonian Students

Keumoe Fozeu

October 2026



South Korea on an equal-area world map
Map created with Equal Earth (equalearths.com)

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Why South Korea?

Diverging paths

In the 1960s, Cameroon and South Korea were in a similar economic situation. Cameroon had recently gained independence, while South Korea had just emerged from the devastating Korean war that left its infrastructure shattered and its economy in ruins. Nonetheless, the trajectories of the two countries subsequently diverged dramatically. Over the following decades, South Korea went through what historians call the "**Miracle on the Han River.**" It underwent one of the most remarkable transformations of the modern era to rebuild and propel its economy.

Today, South Korea is a global titan at the forefront of scientific and technological innovation:

- **Industrial Leadership:** Home to global powerhouses such as Samsung, LG, and Hyundai.
- **Tech Dominance:** A world leader in semiconductors, telecommunications, AI, robotics, materials engineering and automotive engineering.
- **Research Excellence:** Consistently one of the highest R&D spending relative to GDP in the world over the years.

As a Cameroonian who wants to contribute to the development of our country, this difference in the two countries naturally raises two important questions: **how did the Koreans do it? And most importantly, what can we learn from it to optimize our own development efforts?**

These are the questions that sparked my interest in South Korea. This motivated me to inquire about the country and I was very pleased to discover that they have **world-class higher education opportunities available to international students.**

Beyond traditional destinations

When Cameroonian students consider studying abroad, familiar destinations like France, Canada, Germany or the United States often dominate the conversation. However, South Korea offers a distinct and powerful alternative:

- **World-Class Quality:** Korean universities consistently rank among the world's top institutions, particularly in STEM fields, with academic and research excellence at the highest global level.
- **Generous Funding Opportunities:** The government and universities offer massive scholarship schemes that frequently cover full tuition and provide a living stipend.
- **Top-tier safety:** South Korea consistently ranks among the safest nations globally, outperforming traditional study destinations such as France, Germany, Belgium, and the United States in crime indices and public safety metrics.

Key Numbers

South Korea is a safe, student-friendly country leading the way in global innovation...

1

Seoul, the capital, is the world's **best student city**
QS Best Student Cities 2027

10

10th globally in **Societal Safety and Security**
Global Peace Index 2026

2

2nd globally in **R&D spending as a percentage of GDP (5.13%)**
OECD MSTI 2026

4

4th most **innovative economy** in the world
Global Innovation Index 2026

... with world-class institutions.

2027 QS World University Rankings:

38



Seoul National University

42



Yonsei University

52



Korea University

65



Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology

The University Landscape in Korea

Levels of Prestige

Korean universities operate under a widely recognized but informal prestige hierarchy. For clarity, this guide groups them into three unofficial tiers. Although it is unofficial, this hierarchy matters as it can influence career prospects, graduate school admissions, and research opportunities in Korea.

Tier 1 — Korea's Most Prestigious Universities

This group consists of the “SKY” universities and KAIST:

- Seoul National University
- Korea University
- Yonsei University
- Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)

These universities consistently rank among the top 100 universities in the world in the QS World University Rankings. They are also the hardest to get into, both for Korean and international students.

Tier 2 — Highly Regarded Universities

Here are excellent institutions with global recognition, but not quite at the level of the most prominent four. They include:

- Pohang University of Science and Technology (POSTECH)
- Sungkyunkwan University (SKKU)
- Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology (UNIST)
- Hanyang University
- Kyung Hee University
- Daegu Gyeongbuk Institute of Science and Technology (DGIST)
- Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology (GIST)

These are fantastic institutions that still offer world-class education and research opportunities.

Tier 3 — Other Notable Universities

This group contains the other universities across Korea. Admission can be more accessible, and some institutions offer particularly attractive scholarships, English-language programs or specialized programs. Tier 3 universities include:

- Ajou University
- Sejong University
- Ewha Womans University
- Woosong University
- Pusan National University
- Sogang University
- Kyungpook National University

Note that some Tier 3 universities are better than Tier 2 universities and even some Tier 1 universities in specific areas. These areas may be relevant to you, so do not dismiss a university only based on this unofficial tier list.

Choosing a University

It would be a mistake to select a university solely based on world rankings or on prestige. The institution QS identifies as the best university, or that is generally regarded as the most prestigious, may not be the best fit for you.

For example, the SKY universities consistently rank above KAIST in the QS World University Rankings. However, KAIST outperforms all three of them when it comes to STEM (science, engineering, technology, mathematics). Similarly, POSTECH is classified as a Tier 2 university in this list. Yet, it is a STEM powerhouse competing directly with Tier 1 universities, including KAIST.

Furthermore, for international students, factors such as English-language accessibility and overall international friendliness are particularly important. In these areas, it is not uncommon for Tier 2 or Tier 3 universities to outperform institutions in higher tiers. For instance, all courses at UNIST are offered in English, whereas most undergraduate programs at Yonsei are taught primarily in Korean.

We cannot neglect financial considerations either. Some universities in lower tiers offer significantly more generous scholarship packages than their higher-ranked counterparts, making them a more attractive option for many students.

Ultimately, prestige is only one factor among many. Prospective students should also consider subject-specific strengths, international openness, financial aid opportunities, campus and city culture, and career outcomes when choosing a university. **The objective is not to attend the “best” university on paper, but to attend the university that is best for you in particular.**

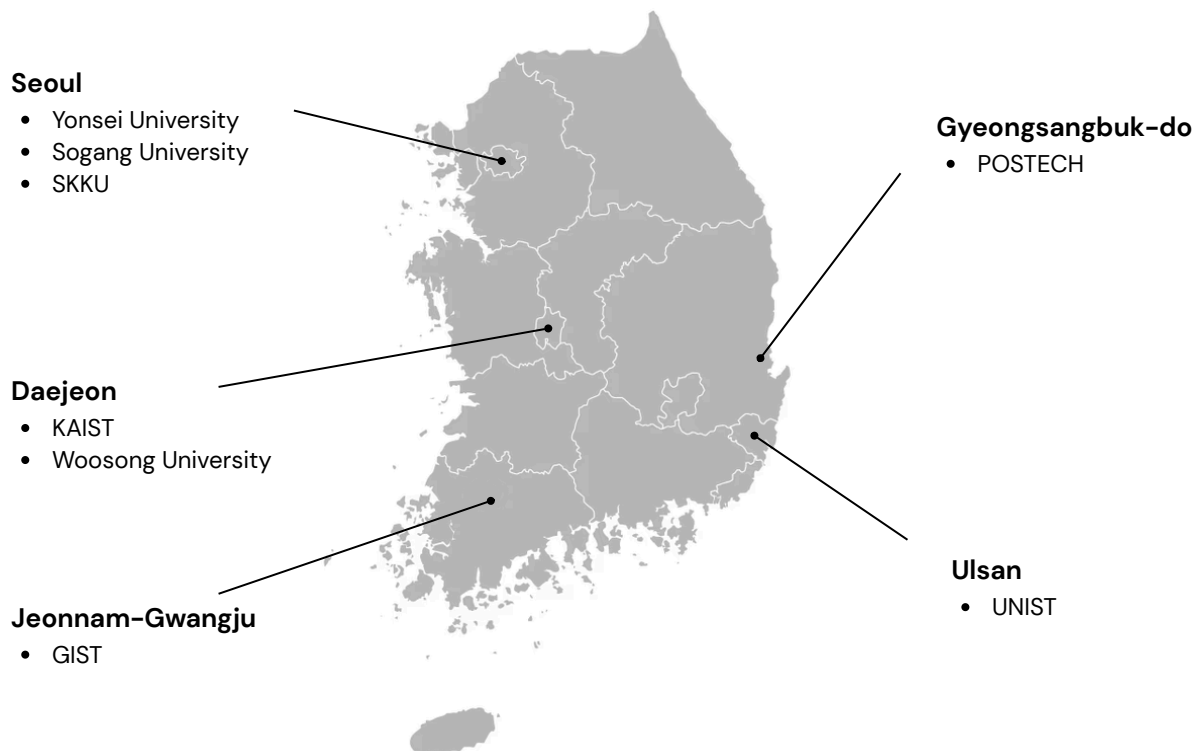
Overview of 8 Korean Universities and their Scholarships

Eight Institutions at a Glance

In this section, we take a closer look at eight Korean universities and the scholarships they offer. These institutions were selected to represent different regions of Korea, varying levels of prestige, and a range of academic strengths, providing a broader view of the opportunities available. The subject-specific rankings are sourced from the Times Higher Education (THE) World University Rankings by Subject 2026. Only scholarships available to international students at admission (undergraduate) are presented here, for they are the most relevant to international applicants.

All financial amounts are expressed in Korean won (KRW), the currency of South Korea. Please refer to the official admissions pages linked below for complete information.

The map below indicates the location of each university featured in this section.



INTERNATIONAL ADMISSION

<https://admission.kaist.ac.kr/intl-undergraduate>

LANGUAGE

All undergraduate programs can be successfully completed in English. Only a few elective courses, mostly in the humanities, are taught exclusively in Korean.

NOTABLE SCHOLARSHIP

KAIST Scholarship:

- 100% tuition for 8 semesters
- 350,000 KRW/month allowance
- Health insurance

Automatically granted upon admission (the applicant only has to indicate interest during the application).

GPA requirement for continued eligibility.



WHY CONSIDER IT

KAIST is Korea's leading university in science and technology. It has exceptionally strong ties with industry, including major companies such as Samsung, LG, and Hyundai.

WORLD RANKINGS

#65 Overall — QS 2027

#32 in Computer Science — THE 2026

#32 in Engineering — THE 2026

#72 in Physical Sciences — THE 2026

Yonsei University

Seoul



INTERNATIONAL ADMISSION

https://www.yonsei.ac.kr/en_sc/2252/subview.do

LANGUAGE

Only the Underwood International College (UIC) offers undergraduate programs in English. These include Political Science and International Relations, Life Science and Biotechnology, and Energy & Environmental Science and Engineering. UIC is a world-class liberal arts college and Yonsei's flagship international program.

NOTABLE SCHOLARSHIP

Admissions Scholarship:

- 100% tuition for 8 semesters

Selective. Separate application not required.
GPA requirement for continued eligibility.



WHY CONSIDER IT

Yonsei is one of Korea's prestigious "SKY" universities and a leading private institution in Asia. UIC is entirely in English language.

WORLD RANKINGS

#42 Overall — QS 2027

#67 in Engineering — THE 2026

#79 in Business and Economics — THE 2026

#82 in Computer Science — THE 2026

Pohang University of Science and Technology (POSTECH)

Pohang



INTERNATIONAL ADMISSION

<https://adm-iu.postech.ac.kr/user/index.do>

LANGUAGE

Starting from Fall 2026, all undergraduate programs are available in English to international students.

NOTABLE SCHOLARSHIP

Tuition scholarship:

- 100% tuition for 8 semesters

Automatically granted upon admission.

Pathfinder Voucher [POSTECH Exclusive]:

- KRW 11,000,000 voucher

Awarded after the third semester.

Arrival Scholarship:

- Airfare reimbursement (up to KRW 2,500,000)

Living allowance:

- KRW 500,000/month



WHY CONSIDER IT

POSTECH is a small but elite STEM powerhouse that directly competes with KAIST in STEM research. As it gains increasing global recognition, it now welcomes international students with English-taught programs and massive scholarships.

WORLD RANKINGS

#106 Overall — QS 2027

#69 in Engineering — THE 2026

Sungkyunkwan University (SKKU)

Seoul & Suwon



INTERNATIONAL ADMISSION

<https://admission-global.skku.edu/eng/index.html>

LANGUAGE

The English Track offers 9 majors spanning biomedicine, engineering, and more.

NOTABLE SCHOLARSHIP

Admission scholarships:

- 10 – 100% tuition for the 1st semester

Automatically granted to applicants with outstanding admission results.

Samsung Global Sungkyun Scholarship for International Students:

- 100% tuition for 8 semesters
- 3,400,000 KRW/semester

Selective. Separate application not required. GPA requirement for continued eligibility.



WHY CONSIDER IT

A top private university, SKKU's unique partnership with Samsung opens pathways to Korea's semiconductor and AI industries.

WORLD RANKINGS

#108 Overall — QS 2027

#40 in Medical and Health — THE 2026

#68 in Engineering — THE 2026

#78 in Computer Science — THE 2026

Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology (UNIST)

Ulsan



INTERNATIONAL ADMISSION

<https://admu-intl.unist.ac.kr/admission-eng/index.do>

LANGUAGE

All programs are taught in English. UNIST is the first university in South Korea to offer 100% lectures in English.

NOTABLE SCHOLARSHIP

Grade Excellence Scholarship:

- 100% or 50% tuition

Awarded to students who are not external scholarship recipients.

For Grade up to the second Academic Year.
GPA requirement for continued eligibility.



WHY CONSIDER IT

UNIST is a research-intensive, startup-friendly university located in Ulsan, Korea's largest industrial city. Founded in 2007, it is already a global leader in key research areas such as carbon neutrality and secondary batteries.

WORLD RANKING

#299 Overall — QS 2027

#5 in Korea for Research Quality — THE 2026

Gwangju Institute of Science and Technology (GIST)

Jeonnam-Gwangju



INTERNATIONAL ADMISSION

<https://www.gist.ac.kr/iuadm/>

LANGUAGE

All basic science and major courses, as well as 15+ elective humanities courses are offered in English. Korean proficiency is not required at admission.

NOTABLE SCHOLARSHIP

Financial aid for all international students:

- 100% tuition for 8 semesters (without any condition)
- KRW 400,000/month allowance + KRW 130,000/month international allowance for 8 semesters (academic requirement for continued eligibility)
- Settlement subsidy of KRW 200,000
- Arrival flight reimbursement



WHY CONSIDER IT

GIST is a national university focused solely on STEM. It admits only about 15 international undergraduates each year, and provides them with substantial scholarships so that they can focus on their studies.

WORLD RANKING

#379 Overall — QS 2027

Sogang University

Seoul



INTERNATIONAL ADMISSION

<https://oisa-admission.sogang.ac.kr/new/html/main/main.asp>

LANGUAGE

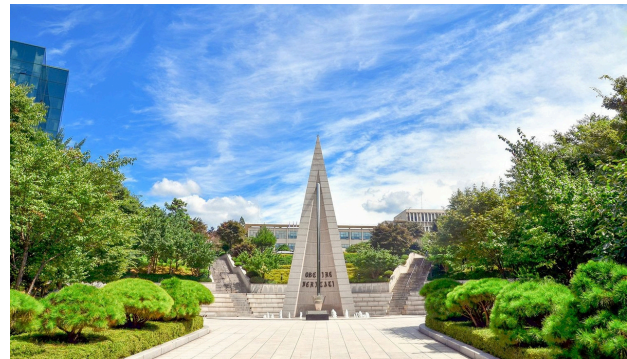
Only a handful of majors are offered in English. They all belong to the humanities, and include Business and Administration, Asian Studies, International Relations, and International Commerce.

NOTABLE SCHOLARSHIP

Sogang Excellence Scholarship I:

- 100% tuition for 8 semesters

Awarded to applicants with the highest entrance score (must be in the top 1%).
GPA requirement for continued eligibility.



WHY CONSIDER IT

Sogang University is a highly regarded Seoul-based university, with strong humanities programs available in English. It has a strong international orientation, with over 1000 international students and academic partnerships with over 370 universities worldwide.

WORLD RANKING

#494 Overall — QS 2027

Woosong University

Daejeon



INTERNATIONAL ADMISSION

<https://english.wsu.ac.kr/page/index.jsp?code=eng0301>

LANGUAGE

There are 13 undergraduate programs taught in English, including Business Administration, AI Management, AI and Big Data, Data Science, K-Beauty Design, and Global Media & Communication Arts.

NOTABLE SCHOLARSHIP

Applicants are automatically evaluated for admission scholarships. These typically cover 30% to 70% of the first semester's tuition. After the first semester, students are eligible for a Merit Scholarship that may cover 100% of the tuition.



WHY CONSIDER IT

With its outstanding international openness and comparatively accessible admissions, Woosong University is a solid option for students who may not be competitive for Korea's most selective universities.

WORLD RANKING

#1 in South Korea for International Outlook — THE 2026

The Global Korea Scholarship Program

An Amazing Opportunity

The **Global Korea Scholarship (GKS) Program** is the Korean government's flagship scholarship for international students. Its mission is to attract the best global talent, strengthen international networks, and deepen mutual friendship with participating countries.

The GKS program is divided into an **Embassy Track** and a **University Track**. Cameroon is not part of GKS' partner countries, so we cannot apply through the Embassy track. Cameroonian applicants have to go through the University Track. Regardless, the financial aid is the same.

The GKS program takes applicants for Bachelor's degrees and Associate degrees. Here, I assume that you are aiming for a Bachelor's degree. In this case, you will be **competing worldwide for 100 places**.

Under the University Track, the destination is one of ten designated universities: Konyang University, Keimyung University, Kookmin University, Daegu University, Dong-A University, Sungshin Women's University, Ajou University, Yeungnam University, Inje University, and Korea University of Technology and Education (KOREATECH). In addition, you can apply to specific STEM majors within these universities.

Eligibility

Here are the key eligibility criteria:

- **Nationality:** Applicants and both of their parents must hold non-Korean citizenship
- **Age:** Applicants must be under 25 years of age as of the applicable year
- **Education:** Graduated or expected to graduate from a high school or an associate degree program
- **Academic Performance:** Applicants must meet academic performance requirements, such as a cumulative score of 80% or higher, ranking within the top 20% of their class, or meeting a CGPA threshold (equal or above 2.64/4.0, 2.80/4.3, 2.91/4.5 or 3.23/5.0).

The complete and authoritative list of criteria can be found in the official guidelines (see the Useful Resources section).

Application Process

For the University Track, applications follow each university's specific schedule and method. Applicants must check each university's announcement of the application procedure and schedule. Nonetheless, the application period will lie between September and November. Results are typically announced in early January.

Evaluation

The selection committee will evaluate each applicant's competency through document screening and an oral interview. As per the official guidelines, factors considered include academic performance, language proficiency, academic activities, contributions to society and international exchange, potential for future development, and the completeness and authenticity of submitted documents.

Scholarship Benefits

The following table summarizes the GKS Program's financial aid.

Scholarship Element	Tuition	Korean Language Program Fee	Entry Airfare	Allowance
Recipient	GKS Scholars during the degree program	GKS Scholars during the Korean language program	All GKS Scholars	All GKS Scholars
Benefits	Admission fee and full tuition waived	KRW 5.2 million per year	Economy class flight ticket	During the Korean language program: KRW 13,560,000 per year During the degree program: KRW 14,400,000 per year

A Fierce Competition

As you can imagine, the GKS scholarship is highly competitive. The same goes for the other scholarships we saw here. You will be competing against excellent students throughout the world for a limited number of places. But do not let it intimidate you because it is very much possible. Hard, but possible. I know because I got admitted to the best STEM university and received one of these scholarships.

Now, I would like to offer specific advice on how you can improve your chances of getting admitted in Korean universities and winning massive scholarships like the GKS.

Advice to Win Admissions and Scholarships

The Six Pillars of a Strong Application

Korean universities generally do not disclose the details of their admission process. Plus, I have never served on an admission committee. So, I do not have official information about how exactly applications are evaluated.

That said, based on my own experience as a successful applicant, conversations with other successful applicants, my understanding of Korean academic culture and institutions, and my experience advising prospective students, I believe that I can offer sensible advice in this topic.

The advice here is written with South Korea in mind. But I believe that it also largely applies to culturally close countries such as China and Japan.

Academic Excellence

In South Korea, you will primarily be judged on your **academic performance**. I have noticed that academic achievement is consistently listed as the first evaluation criterion in admission guides.

If you are targeting Tier 1 universities and full scholarships in particular, academic excellence is non-negotiable. This does not mean getting perfect grades, it means demonstrating a **consistently high level of academic achievement** to convince universities of your academic potential. It seems to me that South Korean universities tend to place a much greater emphasis on academic performance than institutions in Western countries like the US or Canada. It is given more weight in the evaluation process, especially compared to non-academic extracurricular activities such as sports or volunteering.

Naturally, I do not know what each university considers a competitive academic grade. But for reference, I was admitted to KAIST with an IB score of 40/45, and the lowest IB score among admitted students I personally encountered was 36/45. Also, I obtained 16.65/20 in the Baccalauréat in the national system, and I scored 1340 on the SAT. Observe that my SAT score is not exceptional. This suggests that Korean universities may place greater weight on sustained performance in high school and graduation examinations. So, you should not panic if you have barely above average scores in standardized tests such as the SAT and the ACT, as long as your overall academic record remains strong. Besides, these tests are optional in many universities across all tiers.

The picture is somewhat different at many Tier 2 and Tier 3 universities. They are generally less demanding in terms of academic excellence. I believe that scores around 27/45 in the IB or 13/20 in the Baccalauréat may still be competitive. Nevertheless, you want to put in maximum of effort in your studies to achieve the highest academic results possible, in order to expand the range of universities and scholarships realistically available to you.

Proofs of Interest

The second most important element, in my view, is what I call **proofs of interest**. These are activities, projects, and achievements that prove that you are genuinely interested in your desired major.

For example, suppose that you claim to be interested in computer science. Well, what have you done with that interest? What do you have to show for that interest? We need to know otherwise your application risk being too light or appearing inauthentic. You might start or engage in a computer science club, teach programming to your classmates, build useful programs that have some impact (even a minimal local impact), or compete in CS competitions. See, the objective is to **show that your interest is so strong that it forces you to take action**.

Personally, I am interested in mathematics. In my application, I talked about my endeavor to extend the concept of the power of a point into three dimensions, as well as other mathematical explorations like a function to detect prime numbers and an ordering relation in a plane. I also participated and received awards in several international and national mathematics competitions. These are activities and achievements that prove better than words ever could that I am truly passionate about mathematics.

Korean universities will ask you directly or indirectly for proofs of interest. For instance, consider the personal statement prompts used by Sungkyunkwan University for the Fall 2027 application:

1. Please describe any academic achievements or activities related to areas of interest that you pursued during your high school years, along with the outcomes.
2. Please explain in detail your preparation and efforts for studying abroad in Korea.
3. Please describe up to three activities related to the admission unit you are applying for that you pursued with commitment and significance during your high school years.

These three essay prompts are essentially asking the following question:

“What proves that you are really interested in your chosen field or in studying in Korea?”

The same pattern can be found in KAIST and POSTECH application essays. When writing such essays, I believe substance matters more than style, although both are important. An essay with simple words and sentence structures built around compelling evidence of genuine interest will perform better than an elegantly written essay filled with empty words.

It is my belief that proofs of interest constitute such a strong element of your application that in some cases they may compensate for academic results that are good but not exceptional. In my opinion, an applicant with 35/45 in the IB and outstanding proofs of interest is not necessarily less competitive than an applicant with 39/45 in the IB with common extracurricular activities that are unrelated to their field of study. So even though academic excellence remains the number one criterion, proofs of interest are a very close second. Therefore, build, create, explore, collaborate, compete, teach, and engage with the subjects that genuinely interest you.

You will be the first beneficiary of these efforts. Doing activities in fields you are interested in should bring you joy, create wonderful memories, and contribute to your personal growth. In addition, it will help you test your true level of interest. **These benefits remain valuable regardless of the outcome of any university or scholarship application.**

Awards and Recognition

The third most important element of an application is **awards and recognition**. This includes honors, trophies, distinctions, certificates, and other forms of recognition that you typically earn at competitions.

Many Korean universities, especially Tier 1 universities, are looking for **students who stand out from their peers**. Being recognized as the best or among the best at something helps in that regard. So, participate in local, national, and international competitions whenever possible. If these competitions align with your field of interest, it is even better.

In my case, I was a finalist in the International Youth Math Challenge, where I received the Bronze Honor. I also participated in the Breakthrough Junior Challenge, a prestigious global science contest. I did not win this one but the experience was valuable. And that is something I want you to understand: you do not have to win every competition you enter. **Participating itself demonstrates that you are not afraid of taking initiative, putting yourself out there and challenging yourself.** These are qualities that many universities are looking for.

Note that awards and recognition are also closely connected to the first two pillars. An academic award from your school serves as evidence of academic excellence, while a prize (even a participation certificate) in a physics competition constitutes a proof of interest in that field.

They can be particularly helpful if you are applying through Cameroon's national system (especially the francophone section). Korean universities are much less familiar with this system compared to widely recognized ones like the IB. Hence, it might be harder for them to correctly interpret your grades and assess your academic level. Thus, your awards and recognition (as well as proofs of interest) become critical, as they provide **concrete evidence of your abilities regardless of the education system.**

So again, I encourage you to seek out competitive opportunities in your areas of interest. Whether you win or not, the experience will help you grow and demonstrate qualities and abilities that universities value.

Authenticity

My fourth piece of advice is to present an **authentic story**.

In your applications, you will have to write essays that should help the university understand who you are beyond the grades and the extracurricular activities. Here, many students make the mistake of presenting a self-aggrandizing portrayal of themselves. Some exaggerate their achievements, others fall into clichés, some others try to sound smart.

Be yourself. Do not lie in your application. **You do not need to lie, because you are enough, you are deserving.** So be truthful and let your true soul speak in your essays.

For example, do not be afraid to discuss mistakes or setbacks and how you grew from them. I did the same at the time I applied. I wrote about how I was in a very deplorable situation due to my own doing. I explained how I had to reassess myself to grow out of it. I could have written about a time where I was brave and heroic (I had many stories like that), but I chose to be vulnerable and real. Now, I was not part of the admission committee, but I believe that it earned me good points.

Besides, admission officers have read thousands of application essays already. They can detect fakeness and disingenuity, and that will not work in your favor. So, remain authentic. Be yourself.

Vision

The fifth pillar of a strong application is a **strong vision**.

What do you want to study? Why? What are you aiming at in life? Why have you chosen South Korea, and this particular university? How does it all tie to what you want to study and do in life? We should have a good idea of where you are going and why.

Now, you are still in high school. Nobody expects you to have figured out everything at your age. You still have many doubts and hesitations, and you likely have misconceptions about many important things. But at the very least, you should have **some sense of direction**, even if it may change later. Admission officers should feel that you are not going to university just because that is what naturally comes after high school, but because your purpose leads you there.

You should also be able to explain why you are choosing South Korea over other countries, and why you are choosing that particular university. Why do you think that South Korea and this university will get you closer to your aspirations? Some universities will directly ask for this. For instance, the Personal Statement and Study Plan prompt for Seoul National University's 2027 Spring application is:

"Please describe your motivation for your desired course. You may include information related to your preparation for the course and relevant academic achievements. Please state your goals while studying at Seoul National University along with your study plan. Additionally, you may provide a brief description of your personal characteristics."

Note that proofs of interest can help you show that your vision is not just an empty declaration.

Language

Finally, the sixth and final pillar is **language proficiency**.

First of all, English is obviously non-negotiable for English-taught programs. You should be able to follow a course entirely delivered in English, and you will have to prove this to your university. Each university will tell you the proof of English proficiency that it accepts. Some universities require TOEFL or IELTS, while others like KAIST may waive this requirement for students who have studied at an English-medium institution. **You will have to check the English language requirements of each university you are interested in.**

The point I want to emphasize here is **Korean language proficiency**. Yes, you do not need to know Korean to study in Korea. But I strongly believe that having some proficiency in Korean can be a strong asset in your application for two reasons. First, that would constitute an undeniable proof of your interest in Korea. Secondly, I have seen numerous universities provide **admissions scholarships according to the applicant's TOPIK score**. The TOPIK (Test of Proficiency in Korean) is a government-affiliated exam; it can be considered as the TOEFL equivalent for Korean language.

For example, Sungkyunkwan University offers the Scholarship for Excellent Korean Language Professionals which waives 100% of the first semester's tuition for admitted undergraduate students with TOPIK level 6. POSTECH offers a one-time incentive of KRW 300,000 to international undergraduate students who obtain TOPIK level 4 or higher.

Now, learning a language is time-consuming. You can absolutely get into a good university with good scholarship without knowing Korean. I for one did not know a single word of Korean when I was admitted. My point is simply that, for someone who is really serious and determined to study in Korea, having some proficiency in Korean can make a positive difference in their application.

Final Thoughts

These are my six most important pieces of advice for building a strong application to the best universities and scholarships in South Korea. They helped me gain admission to KAIST, and they also helped other Cameroonian and foreign students I have supported with their applications to Korean universities. So, the advice here can definitely help you too. I am sharing these with you because I genuinely believe that you have what it takes to seize the best higher education opportunities in South Korea.

All the best.

Useful Resources

Official Government Resources

National Institute for International Education (NIIED)

The agency of the Ministry of Education in charge of international education.

<https://niied.go.kr/web/niied/niiedEng/main>

Study in Korea

The government's information hub about higher education opportunities in South Korea.

<https://www.studyinkorea.go.kr/ko/main.do>

Global Korea Scholarship

The Korean government's flagship scholarship program for international students.

<https://www.studyinkorea.go.kr/ko/plan/scholarship.do>

TOPIK (Test of Proficiency in Korean)

The official Korean language proficiency exam, administered by NIIED.

<https://www.topik.go.kr>

Korea Immigration Service

The information portal about rules and policies of immigration in South Korea.

https://www.immigration.go.kr/immigration_eng/index.do

Embassy of the Republic of Korea in Cameroon

The official Korean diplomatic mission in Cameroon.

<https://www.mofa.go.kr/cm-en/index.do>

University Rankings

QS World University Rankings

One of the most widely recognized university rankings, published by Quacquarelli Symonds.

<https://www.topuniversities.com/world-university-rankings>

Times Higher Education World University Rankings

A prominent university ranking highly trusted by academics and governments worldwide.

<https://www.timeshighereducation.com/world-university-rankings/latest/world-ranking>

About Me

My name is **Keumoe Fozou Richy**. I went to South Korea to study Mathematical Sciences at the Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST) with a 100% scholarship. After personally navigating the Korean university and scholarship landscape, and after supporting several students in their applications, I created this guide to help Cameroonian students discover and pursue higher-education opportunities in South Korea.

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Explore my work

My work spans mathematics and African thought:

GitHub — github.com/KeumoeFozou

Solutions to Tao's Analysis I — github.com/KeumoeFozou/solutions-tao-analysis

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